

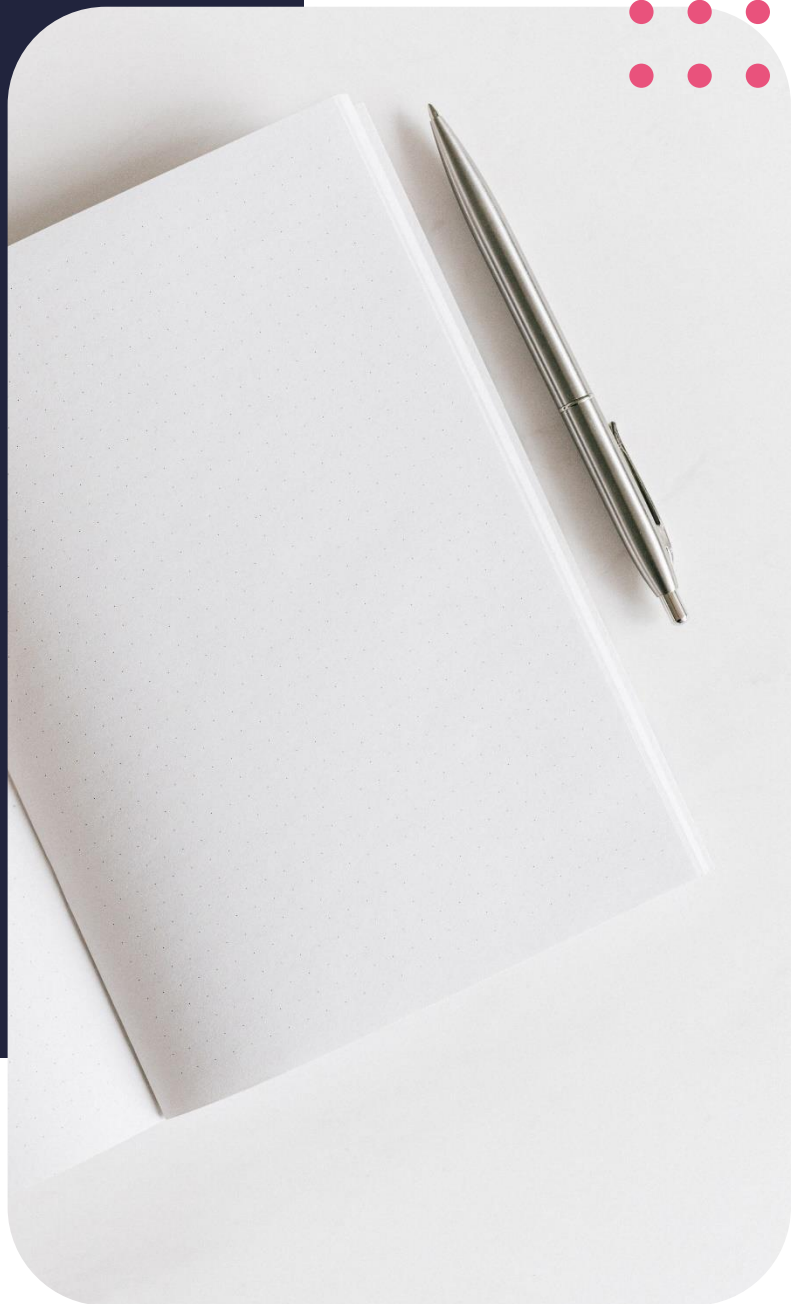
Diploma in Leadership & Management

Why is Leadership so Important in the Workplace



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Lesson 3 Objectives

- Why leadership makes a difference
- Dimensions of leadership
- Lead with resolve and humility

Lesson Introduction

Leaders use humility and integrity to lead their teams. Humility and integrity lead to trust. And we see that trust is needed to have effective team leadership and management.

“There is nothing noble in being superior to your fellow man; true nobility is being superior to your former self.”
— Ernest Hemingway



Key Reading Materials

- <https://www.businessmanagementideas.com/management/importance-of-leadership/importance-of-leadership/19741>
- <https://www.ispatguru.com/importance-of-leadership-for-organizational-excellence/>
- <https://www.toppr.com/guides/business-studies/directing/leadership/>
- <https://sarahcordiner.com/10-ways-to-lead-with-humility/>

Self-Assessment

- Test your grit: <https://angeladuckworth.com/grit-scale/>

Why leadership makes a difference

According to (Blank, 2018), the following factors should be considered when wanting to make a difference.

Identify your passion

Make a difference when you find your passion regarding work-related things. Invest in a project or a role in your company. By being passionate, you will find that as a leader you're making a real difference and adding value to the company.

Don't depend on others to act

As leaders and managers, you have to set the pace and take the first step. You can't wait for everything to fall apart or not work before taking action. You can be proactive and make a difference by thinking about the future and what the company and employees need.

Rethink risk

We have to get used to taking risks. It takes time to get comfortable with taking a personal and professional risk. The aim is to take risks that will pay off in your professional life. For example, you want to enter a new market at work, so you set up and head the marketing campaign.

Look for respect and not likeability

I have asked recruits this question so many times, would you rather be liked or respected. Most people say a mix of both. As managers and leaders, it's more important to have employees respect you as a leader and your decisions than liking you.

Your legacy

Think of what you're creating and what you want to leave behind at the end of the day. Plan with the end in mind. When you leave the company, what do you want to leave behind? Create a legacy for yourself that will make you a great example of how a leader and manager should be.

How to develop your leadership style



As stated by (Wrike, 2017), there are several ways you can develop your leadership style. Make sure to really look at these guidelines to see where you can improve and what support you need. Evaluate yourself and take the results to your company or managers to set up a support plan.

Practice discipline

Please make sure to take the grit test that I linked at the top of the document. Good leaders and managers need to be disciplined. This means that you are able to effectively reach your goals and objectives without giving up. You set yourself up for success when you push beyond the tough times to reach to the other side.

Take on more projects

A great way to develop your leadership style is by taking on new projects and tasks that will challenge you. The aim is to build your skills and competencies by taking on new things. You will be able to develop yourself, your problem-solving skills and take your new skills back to your team. This is a great approach to take to better-coach and mentor employees as you know what they're doing.

Learn to follow

This seems like an odd way to develop your leadership style but it works. You need to understand how to follow before leading. See which leadership styles work for you as a follower and learn from that. At times you need your team or employees to take the lead and then you have to step back and follow. We need to be able to do both in order to be effective leaders and managers.

Develop situational awareness

Make sure that you're keeping your eye on the bigger picture. This is a very important skill to build as you can plan day-to-day tasks around meeting the objectives of the big picture. You can speak to your manager or leader to help develop these skills if you're struggling. Look for someone who does this very well and learns from them.

Tips for new leaders



According to the (DeWitt, 2014), here are top tips for new leaders.

Ask questions

“I make a rule that about 50% of the words coming out of my mouth should end with a question mark in the first 30 days.” Take the first couple of months to ask questions and really understand the break-down of the company. Understand the people you work with, the systems that the company has in place, and the reason some approaches are taken. It’s important to understand something before making changes.

Understand what people want

Take the time to understand the good and the bad about the company. Understand what employees want, what they need and what their company is not offering. This is a great way to set up effective motivation tools that will help you with your team management.

Get your hands dirty

It’s very important to really jump in and support your team. Take on different tasks to help reduce the workload of your team and also to understand what they’re doing to get the job done. By doing the different jobs or activities you can better evaluate where the team is winning and where they’re losing. You can come up with better solutions because you can relate better with your team.

Be decisive

This is very important as you need to make decisions and stick to them. Allow yourself to make the tough decisions and deal with the consequences. The employees will respect a manager and leader that can make a

tough call and stick to it. You can make adjustments based on feedback to improve the decision but you cannot waste time before jumping to action.

Lead with humility

As stated by (Cordiner, 2019), there are several signs of a leader leading without humility.

- “They are ‘proud’ and fiercely defend their pride”
- “They are arrogant, egotistical and pretentious”
- “They focus on the failings, weaknesses and shortcomings of those around them”
- “They won’t admit their own weaknesses or shortcomings”
- “They are defensive”
- “They fight for their viewpoint, convinced that they are right and everyone else is wrong”
- “They have an inability to use the word ‘sorry’”

Top ways to lead with humility



Share the power

It can be tough to share power with your team. You may not trust them or you have not been with the team long enough to understand how each team member will react with power. The aim of humility leadership is to empower your team. Give your team members the power to make decisions for themselves. For example, give your employees time to add ideas when it comes to creating KPIs or a bonus structure. Give them the power to give input and help set up these structures.

Think of others and not of yourself

It's important to think of how your decisions and actions will impact those around you. This also includes a strong level of emotional intelligence. We need leaders with humility to think of those around them more than think of their own needs first.

Give more credit to others

Humility allows leaders and managers to give credit to their teams. Employees can feel frustrated when they feel they are not being acknowledged for their contribution. We need leaders and managers to give credit where credit is due.

Ask how you can help

Check in with your team and help them where you can. For example, take on a task for one of your employees. This can mean that the employee can focus on other tasks and you can relieve some pressure off of the employee.

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